Week 5 Enabling Activities

Values, Heuristics & Bias

This set covers the full six-activity family for Values, Heuristics & Bias, organized as two tracks: 1a–1c build the Value → Assumption → Competing Framework move in stages; 4a–4c test whether it has proceduralized. These supplement — they do not replace — this week's folder and the ESO/Frames Daily Protocol.

This Week's Frame — Values, Heuristics & Bias (W5)

Value	Assumption	Competing Framework
What does this stakeholder believe is important?	What must be true for that value to justify their position?	What does a stakeholder on the other side believe instead?

Key requirement: the competing framework must reflect a genuinely different value system — not a restatement of the same value with different specifics, and not a strawman. A response that only describes one side's reasoning, or invents an implausible opposing view, does not meet the standard for this frame.

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Activity 1a · Depth Ladder

Single-Scenario Depth Ladder — "Scaffold the Scaffold"

Holds one low-stakes scenario constant while building the Value → Assumption → Competing Framework move in four steps. Use before a student's first W5 attempt, or as remediation if the competing framework isn't yet a genuinely different value.

ANCHOR SCENARIO (HELD CONSTANT ACROSS ALL FOUR ITEMS)

A company uses AI software to screen job applicants' resumes.

1 **Surface**
"What value drives support for AI resume screening?"
Name one value only (for example, efficiency or standardized fairness).

2 **Surface → Deep**
"What has to be true about the AI system for that value to actually justify using it?"
Add the Assumption box — what must hold for the value to be a good reason.

3 **Deep**
"Supporters value efficient, standardized screening. Critics, however, value ___."
Complete the Competing Framework — a genuinely different value system, not the same value restated.

4 **Transfer**
"Should landlords be allowed to use AI to screen rental applicants?"
Full response: value + assumption + competing framework, no connector given.

Instructor note: 5–10 minute warm-up. A student who completes Item 4 without hesitation is ready for the Week 5 folder.

Activity 1b · Sentence-Frame Progression

Causal Subordination → Concessive Subordination → Appositive

Builds subordinate-clause complexity in three tiers using connectors that read as ILR 2+/3, not just connectors that are technically subordinating. Coordinating conjunctions (FANBOYS) are excluded — and so are 'because' and 'so': both are grammatically fine, but they're exactly the safe, overused connectors that inflate a proficiency ceiling. T1 uses higher-register causal subordinators with more precision.

SCENARIO

A company uses AI software to screen job applicants' resumes.

T1

Causal subordination — given that / on the grounds that / considering that

Complete each sentence, naming one value.

- "Supporters back AI resume screening given that ___."
- "Hiring managers are willing to adopt the software on the grounds that ___."
- "Some applicants remain wary of the system considering that ___."

T2

Concessive subordination — although / while / even though

Hold two competing values in tension inside one sentence.

- "While efficiency-focused hiring teams welcome faster screening, applicants who value individualized consideration ___."
- "Although the system treats every resume by the same standard, critics who prioritize human judgment ___."
- "Even though supporters emphasize consistency, those who value contextual fairness ___."

T3

Appositives — "Fact, ___, Fact"

Embed a stakeholder's value identity as a defining phrase inside the sentence.

MODEL

"Hiring managers, the primary beneficiaries of faster, standardized screening, welcome the AI system's consistency, while applicants, bearing the cost of decisions made without human context, argue that efficiency was privileged over fairness."

Instructor note: 'because' and 'so' aren't FANBOYS, but they're the safe, overused connectors that flag a proficiency ceiling. T1 swaps them for 'given that' / 'on the grounds that' / 'considering that' — same causal entry point, higher register from the first sentence. Move to T2 only once T1 is fluent. T3 stretch — optional for students still consolidating the core requirement.

Activity 1c · 3-Interval Comparison

Comparison & Paraphrase Prompts

Connects values/bias vocabulary to comparative sentence structures, moving from a simple one-line comparison to a claim that explicitly names competing priorities.

COMPARISON PAIR

How supporters and critics of AI resume screening weigh the same efficiency-versus-fairness trade-off differently.

Target Lexicon — must appear at least once

- underlying assumption
- competing priorities
- at odds with
- privileges
- on balance

1 **Surface**
"In one sentence, compare what supporters of AI screening value most with what critics value most."

2 **Deep**
"Using underlying assumption, explain what a supporter has to believe about the software for their value to hold up."

3 **Transfer**
"Write one complex sentence connecting the two competing values, using at odds with or privileges."

Instructor note: score for lexicon use and whether the competing framework is a genuinely different value — not for which side the student takes.

Activity 4a · 2-Box Induction

Visual Synthesis

Forces students to identify how two reasonable positions can reach opposite conclusions from identical facts — no rule is stated up front.

SHARED FACTS (BOTH BOXES WORK FROM THIS)

A city is deciding whether to allow a new large retail store to open on the edge of downtown. The store would create 200 jobs and offer lowe prices, but it would likely put several small, family-owned shops out of business.

Box A

• The store should be allowed to open — 200 new jobs and lower prices benefit far more residents than the small number of shop owners affected.

• Efficiency and broad access matter more than protecting a handful of existing businesses.

Box B

• The store should not be allowed to open — those 200 jobs come at the direct cost of family livelihoods that took years to build.

• A community's character and the people who built it deserve protection, even if it means slightly higher prices for everyone else.

TASK

Box A and Box B are working from the exact same facts. What value is each box prioritizing? Why do two reasonable people, looking at identical information, reach opposite conclusions?

Instructor note: Box A prioritizes broad economic efficiency; Box B prioritizes community continuity and protecting existing livelihoods. Neither box is wrong — that's the point of this frame. Let the student name both values before you confirm them.

Activity 4b · Silent Protocol

Silent Modeling & Pre-Attempt Brief-Back

Separates rule comprehension from production. Students extract the frame's structure from a marked-but-unexplained model, then must plan out loud before they're allowed to attempt their own response.

PHASE 1 — SILENT MODELING

Read the response below. Three elements are marked [A], [B], [C]. No explanation is given — identify what each represents before moving to Phase 2.

[A] Hiring managers who adopt AI screening value consistency — treating every applicant against the exact same criteria, without the fatigue or mood swings that affect a human reviewer's tenth interview of the day. **[B]** That value only justifies the tool if the criteria themselves are neutral — if the algorithm was trained on data that doesn't quietly favor certain names, schools, or zip codes over others. **[C]** Critics start from a different value entirely: they believe every applicant deserves individualized human judgment, and that no amount of statistical consistency makes up for a process that can't explain, in a given case, why a specific person was rejected.

Key (reveal only after Phase 2). In the digital version, each move is color-highlighted. In print, use letter markers above.

	[A] = Value		**[B]** = Assumption		**[C]** = Competing Framework

PHASE 2 — VERBAL BRIEF-BACK ("PLAN BEFORE YOU PRODUCE")

Before attempting your own response to the prompt below, say out loud — or write in one sentence — your plan for each of the frame's three moves. Do not begin your full response until you've stated your plan.

PROMPT FOR PHASE 2 ATTEMPT

"Should universities use AI to screen college applications?"

Instructor note: the brief-back is a planning checkpoint, not a rehearsal — keep it to one sentence. This models a legitimate strategy: a brief pause to organize before speaking.

Activity 4c · Strategic Competence

Fallback Scaffolding

Tests whether the frame's core move survives without its own vocabulary — the ILR 3 skill of knowing what to do when the exact word isn't available.

CONSTRAINT

Answer the prompt below without using the words value, assumption, or competing framework.

PROMPT

"Should landlords be allowed to use AI to screen rental applicants?"

Fallback Strategies to Practice

a **Circumlocution**
Instead of "value," try "what matters most to them" or "what they care about."

b **Term substitution**
Instead of "assumption" / "competing framework," try "what has to be true for that to make sense" / "what the other side belie instead."

c **Self-correction**
"What I mean is..." / "Let me put that another way..."

d **Hedging**
"It seems to matter most to..." / "This tends to conflict with..."

Instructor note: use after a student is reliably using the frame vocabulary — this is a stress test, not a first attempt.